Contract Review Governance and Controls

Introduction

This document outlines HelioFreight Logistics' governance expectations for managing commercial contract changes across warehousing and freight services. It establishes consistent controls that support speed, risk awareness, and alignment with customer and carrier obligations. The guidance is intended for Sales, Legal, Operations, and Finance teams participating in contract negotiation workflows. Standardizing these practices reduces cycle time while preserving commercial and compliance safeguards.

Negotiation Intake and Triage Standards

Before initiating contract redline approvals, the negotiator must prepare proposed fallback wording and complete the RSS-14 to summarize all non-standard clauses and identify internal deviation owners, as this enables fast and accurate specialist review. During intake, the contract owner runs the CLM Special Reviews Gate using the deal scope, shipment profile, and customer requirements to determine whether additional review lanes are required beyond the base routing. If the customer requests insurance limits above HelioFreight's standard, Risk Management is added; if the scope includes hazmat movements or temperature-controlled regulated freight, the designated Risk/Compliance reviewer is included per policy. If the agreement requires customer system or API access or involves processing personal data, InfoSec and/or Privacy reviewers are added and the appropriate security and privacy addenda are attached to the CLM record so reviewers evaluate the complete, correct package. When none of these triggers apply, no specialist reviewers are added and the request proceeds on the standard approval path to avoid unnecessary cycle time. Contract owners must confirm that all required addenda are attached prior to submission, since missing artifacts commonly cause rework and delays in final sign-off.

Conclusion

Consistent application of these guidelines improves coordination across teams and increases predictability in contract outcomes. Clear ownership, defined thresholds, and standardized documentation help prevent avoidable delays and reduce operational exposure. Adhering to the controls in this manual supports faster customer onboarding and cleaner handoffs to execution teams. Deviations should be documented and escalated according to established governance.